

MAKET LAKAY

Application Flow

A complete walkthrough of how customers, vendors, and administrators move through the platform — including the Stripe Connect payment flow.

Multi-vendor marketplace for Haiti and the Haitian diaspora
Next.js · TypeScript · Supabase · Stripe Connect
Prepared 2026-08-21

Contents

- 1. Overview
- 2. Customer Flow
- 3. Vendor Flow
- 4. Admin Flow
- 5. Payment Flow (Stripe Connect)
- 6. Roles & Access
- 7. Current Status

1. Overview

Maket Lakay is a multi-vendor e-commerce marketplace connecting independent sellers — based in Haiti and across the Haitian diaspora — with customers through a single storefront. The platform handles checkout, order management, delivery coordination, and customer support centrally, while each vendor manages their own products and store.

Three roles drive the platform: **customers** who browse and buy, **vendors** who list and fulfill products, and **admin/support staff** who approve vendors, moderate content, and resolve issues. A fourth actor, **Stripe**, handles identity verification and payment settlement for real card transactions.

2. Customer Flow

2.1 Discovery & Browsing

1. Customer lands on the homepage — trending, new arrival, recommended, and deal sections pull from the live product catalog.
2. Browses by category, searches by keyword, or visits a specific vendor's store page.
3. Views a product detail page: description, price, stock, reviews, related products, and the selling store's profile.

2.2 Account & Sign-up

1. Sign-up requires only name, email, and password. A `profiles` row (role: *customer* by default) is created automatically.
2. Signed-in customers get a persistent account area: saved addresses, wishlist, order history, and submitted reviews.

2.3 Cart & Checkout

Step	What happens
------	--------------

Add to cart	Items are grouped automatically by which vendor/store sells them.
Delivery address	Customer selects a saved address or adds a new one.
Delivery method	Standard, Express, or Pickup — fee and ETA vary by real delivery-zone data.
Payment method	Card (Stripe), MonCash, NatCash, Bank Transfer, or a declined-test option for previewing failure handling.
Order review	Final confirmation of address, delivery method, payment method, and per-vendor line items.
Place order	Payment is confirmed, then one order is created <i>per vendor</i> in the cart (a single checkout can produce several orders if it spans multiple sellers).

Card payments are currently disabled platform-wide while the account transitions to Stripe Connect (see Section 5). MonCash, NatCash, Bank Transfer, and the declined-test option remain fully functional simulations.

2.4 Post-purchase

1. Order confirmation page, then live order tracking with a status timeline (pending → confirmed → processing → ready for delivery → out for delivery → delivered).
2. Customer can message support, open a dispute, or request a refund tied to a specific order.
3. After delivery, customer can leave a product review and a store review.

3. Vendor Flow

3.1 Becoming a Vendor

1. A signed-in customer applies at `/sell` — a multi-step form (seller identity, legal/ID details, store profile, payout preferences).
2. The application is reviewed by an admin at `/admin/vendors`.
3. On approval, a real vendor account and store are created automatically, and the applicant's role is promoted to *vendor*.

3.2 Vendor Dashboard

Area	Purpose
------	---------

Overview	Sales, orders, ratings, and a setup checklist (store approved, first product added, delivery preferences, payout review, Stripe Connect).
Products & Inventory	Create/edit listings, manage stock levels, track low-stock alerts.
Orders	View incoming orders, move them through the delivery workflow (confirm → process → ship → deliver), which also creates real delivery-assignment and tracking records.
Promotions	Create discount campaigns scoped to the vendor's own products.
Earnings & Wallet	A derived (not manually edited) balance: lifetime sales, commission owed, pending vs. available balance.
Payout Requests	Vendor requests a payout from their available balance; an admin approves, processes, or rejects it.
Store Settings	Storefront details, branding, delivery preferences, policies — and the Stripe Connect payout connection (Section 5).
Disputes & Reviews	Respond to customer disputes and view/reply to product & store reviews.

4. Admin Flow

Area	Purpose
Vendors	Review and approve/reject applications; manage vendor status (active/suspended); view Stripe Connect payout status per vendor.
Products	Moderate listings platform-wide.
Orders	Oversee every order regardless of vendor; change status; flag for review; issue refunds.
Commissions	Set the default commission rate and per-vendor overrides.
Delivery Zones	Configure delivery fees and estimated delivery times by region — feeds directly into what customers are charged at checkout.
Support	The shared workbench for support tickets, disputes, and refund requests across all roles; also handles escalations.
Payout Requests	Approve, process, or reject vendor payout requests.
Payout Reconciliation (<i>new</i>)	Lists any card-paid order whose Stripe Connect transfer to the vendor failed or is still pending — a manual follow-up queue.
Users	View every account; promote a user to vendor/admin/support.

5. Payment Flow (Stripe Connect)

Because Maket Lakay is a marketplace — one checkout can pay several independent vendors — card payments are processed through **Stripe Connect** rather than a standard merchant account. Each vendor is individually onboarded and paid directly.

5.1 Vendor Payout Onboarding

Vendor opens Store Settings → picks their country → clicks "Connect with Stripe" → completes Stripe's own hosted verification form (identity, bank account) → redirected back to Maket Lakay → status syncs to "Active"

Maket Lakay never sees or stores the vendor's identity documents or bank details — that data goes directly to Stripe. Currently, onboarding requires a business or bank account in a country Stripe supports directly (e.g. the United States, Canada, France) — not Haiti. In practice this means **diaspora-based vendors** can complete payout setup today; support for Haiti-based vendors depends on Stripe expanding country coverage.

5.2 Checkout Gating

"Card" only appears as a selectable payment method when **every** vendor represented in the cart has completed Stripe Connect onboarding. If even one seller hasn't finished setup, Card is shown disabled with an explanation, and the customer can still complete checkout with another payment method.

5.3 Charge & Payout Split

Maket Lakay uses the *Separate Charges and Transfers* pattern: the customer's card is charged once, for the full order total, into the platform's own Stripe balance. Immediately afterward, the platform transfers each vendor's share (order subtotal minus the marketplace commission) directly to that vendor's own connected Stripe account.

Customer confirms card payment → Maket Lakay's server re-verifies the payment with Stripe → the order is recorded → a transfer is sent to each vendor's Stripe account for their share → order confirmation shown to the customer

The order is recorded **before** any transfer is attempted, so if a transfer fails for any reason, the customer's order is never lost — it's simply flagged for admin follow-up in the Payout Reconciliation view (Section 4).

5.4 What Stays Simulated

MonCash, NatCash, Bank Transfer, and the declined-test payment option remain frontend simulations by design — no real money moves through them regardless of Stripe's configuration status.

6. Roles & Access

Role	Access
CUSTOMER	Marketplace, cart, checkout, account, orders, tracking, support.
VENDOR	Everything under <code>/vendor</code> — scoped to their own store(s).
SUPPORT	Shares <code>/admin/support</code> , <code>/admin/orders</code> , <code>/admin/vendors</code> , <code>/admin/products</code> with admin.
ADMIN	Full platform oversight — everything above plus approvals, commissions, delivery-zone configuration, and reporting.

New sign-ups default to *customer*. Vendor access is granted only through the real application-and-approval flow. Admin/support access is granted by an existing admin promoting a user from `/admin/users` .

7. Current Status

Area	Status
Core marketplace (catalog, cart, orders, tracking)	Live
Vendor onboarding, products, delivery, promotions, wallet	Live
Customer addresses, wishlist, reviews	Live
Support tickets, disputes, refund requests, escalations	Live
Admin oversight, commissions, delivery zones	Live
Stripe Connect vendor onboarding & payout splitting	Live (diaspora vendors only)
Card payments at checkout	Disabled — pending go-live decision
MonCash / NatCash / Bank Transfer	Simulated by design
Email confirmation on sign-up	Disabled — needs production SMTP
Leaked-password protection	Disabled — requires a paid Supabase plan

